

VAMPIRE SURVIVORS

In a complex world, simple is rare and appreciated

By Manish "Trigger Happy" Rajesh | feedback@skoar.in

Vampire Survivors has no business being as addictive as it is. If you've been following the magazine for these past few months, then you would have seen mention of the game somewhere or the other. Be it in someone's (most probably mine) column, or in the Digit Diary. That would be because we picked the game up way back in February and are still playing it to this day. Most of us have easily racked up over 100 hours in the game, and that's not including the time we spent playing the free demo on itch.io! I don't know about you guys, but I would say that's ₹125 well spent! So what is it about Vampire Survivors that makes it so addictively good? Let's find out.

Gameplay

There's no complicated mechanics or controls; VS is as simple as it gets, at least when it comes to the controls. WASD, or the arrow keys if you prefer, to

move your character around. That's it. The game can be described as a reverse bullet hell, or a single-stick shooter, if you will. Essentially, the character is constantly firing projectiles or a weapon of some kind or the other. Your job is to navigate your character in order to kill approaching enemies and keep your character alive, that's it. Simple premise, but easier said than done.

Enemies

In detail, enemies in the game beeline straight for your character, with the goal obviously being to kill you. Meanwhile, your job is to navigate around or away from these approaching enemies, and line whatever weapons you've got in your arsenal up in a way that kills them. The enemies are as simple as they get, and while there may be variations in the way they look, they all behave the same way. Even the boss monsters are just bigger, beefier versions of the regular critters for the most part. On death,

regular critters have a chance of dropping xp gems, while boss monsters will drop chests. These play an important role when it comes to weapons.

Weapons

Coming to weapons, the game has quite a few as of writing this review. Each of them are unique in some way or the other. For instance, the very first character available to you, Antonio, starts with a whip. When you start off, the whip attacks enemies in an arc in the direction you're facing, you know, like a whip. Once you level the whip up, it starts doing this on both the front and back. Following levels increase the area, base damage and so on. Then you've got the magic wand, which simply fires a projectile at the nearest enemy. Leveling this up reduces the cooldown between projectiles, increases the number of projectiles and allows them to pass through enemies. This system applies to every weapon in the game,